

3. Comparative historical analyses reveal cultural variations, with one study offering a direct contrast between Western and non-Western elite structures.

These studies show that ruling elite dynamics involve both persistent classical ideas and innovative approaches suited to a global, networked era.

Paper search

Using your research question "_____ research report / _____ -
(_____, _____, _____) 2000-2025 _____ .

- _____ : _____ , _____ , _____ .
- _____ : _____ - _____ , _____ + _____ , _____ , _____ . / - _____ , _____ , _____ , _____ .
- _____ : _____ ; _____ , _____ .

1. _____ (1-3 _____) _____ : _____ , _____ / _____ , _____ (_____ . / _____ . / _____) , _____ .
2. _____ (_____ - _____) : _____
- _____ vs _____ - _____ .
- « _____ » (_____ , _____ , _____ , _____ , _____) vs _____ (_____ , _____ , _____ , _____ , _____) .
3. _____ , _____ world-building.

(power elite OR ruling elite OR governing elite OR political elite) AND (intra-elite conflict OR elite competition OR factionalism OR elite rivalry OR elite circulation OR leadership succession OR political factions OR power struggle) NOT (cultural elite OR intellectual elite)

- _____ : 2000-2025 (_____ 2000 _____ - _____) .
- _____ working papers (SSRN, IDEAS), _____ . ”, we searched across over 126 million academic papers from the Semantic Scholar corpus. We retrieved the 50 papers most relevant to the query.

Data extraction

We asked a large language model to extract each data column below from each paper. We gave the model the extraction instructions shown below for each column.

• Theoretical Perspective on Elites:

Identify the primary theoretical framework or approach used to analyze political/ruling elites in the study:

- Classify the theoretical approach (e.g., classical elite theory, network analysis, field theory, patron-client theory)
- If multiple approaches are used, list them in order of prominence
- Quote direct theoretical references or key theoretical statements from the text
- Note any unique or innovative theoretical contributions

Guidance:

- Look in introduction, theoretical framework, and discussion sections

- If no explicit theoretical framework is stated, infer from the analytical approach
- If multiple perspectives are equally weighted, note "mixed approach"

- **Geographical and Contextual Focus:**

Specify the geographical region and political context of the elite study:

- Primary geographical region/country
- Type of political system (democracy, authoritarian, hybrid regime)
- Specific sub-national context if relevant (e.g., specific region, urban/rural)

Guidance:

- Prioritize explicit statements about geographical focus
- If multiple contexts are discussed, list in order of prominence
- Use standard geographical classifications
- If no specific context is mentioned, write "Not specified"

- **Research Methodology:**

Identify the primary research methodology:

- Classify as quantitative, qualitative, or mixed methods
- Specify specific research methods (e.g., network analysis, case study, comparative analysis, historical analysis)
- Note key data collection techniques (interviews, document analysis, statistical analysis)

Guidance:

- Prioritize explicit methodology statements in methods section
- If methodology is not clearly stated, infer from research design and data analysis
- If multiple methods are used, list in order of prominence

- **Intra-Elite Dynamics Focus:**

Identify specific aspects of intra-elite dynamics examined:

- Types of elite conflicts (factionalism, competition, succession)
- Power relations within elite groups
- Mechanisms of elite circulation or reproduction

Guidance:

- Search introduction, methods, and findings sections
- Extract direct quotes describing elite dynamics
- If no specific intra-elite dynamics are discussed, write "Not specified"
- Prioritize explicit discussions of power relationships and conflicts

- **Primary Research Findings:**

Summarize the key findings related to elite dynamics:

- Main empirical or theoretical conclusions
- Significant patterns or mechanisms identified
- Novel insights into elite behavior or structure

Guidance:

- Focus on results and discussion sections
- Extract 2-3 most significant findings
- Use direct quotes where possible
- Ensure findings directly relate to elite dynamics

Results

Characteristics of Included Studies

Study	Study Focus	Geographic Region	Theoretical Framework	Key Findings	Full text available for review
Duka, 2008	Theoretical analysis of frameworks for studying elites; proposes three research directions (functional groups, social layer, institutions)	No mention found	Mixed approach: Classical elite theory (functional groups, social layer), Institutional theory (elites as institutions)	Outlines three theoretical perspectives for elite study; no empirical findings	No
Zubarev, 2023	Theoretical/conceptual analysis of the evolution of elite theory in modern states	No mention found	Classical elite theory, Network analysis (mixed approach)	Expands research perspectives on elites, emphasizing network management and continuity from classical theory	No
Masiutkina, 2021	Qualitative, historical and conceptual analysis of the crisis and internal conflict of American political elites	United States	Classical elite theory (hegemonism, creative minority), elements of patron-client and field theory	Documents crisis of identity, factionalism, and elite circulation failure among United States elites; rise of clientelism and manipulation	Yes

Study	Study Focus	Geographic Region	Theoretical Framework	Key Findings	Full text available for review
Musaeva, 2024	Qualitative, comparative historical analysis of elite roles in societal transformation	Western Europe (Italy, Netherlands), Arab-Muslim civilization	No mention found (comparative historical approach)	Distinguishes "true" and "pseudo" elites; shows elite-driven societal transformation in both Western and non-Western contexts	No
Golovin and Golovina, 2021	Theoretical/conceptual analysis of transnational and digital elites in the global context	Global context	Mixed approach: Network analysis, Field theory, postmodern philosophy	Describes rise of transnational and digital elites, blurring of national boundaries, and new forms of elite power	No

Study Focus:

- Three studies primarily present theoretical or conceptual analyses.
- One study provides a qualitative, historical, and conceptual analysis of political elites in the United States.
- One study offers a qualitative, comparative historical analysis of elite roles in societal transformation.

Geographic Region:

- No mention found of a specific geographic region in three studies.
- One study focuses on the United States.
- One study covers Western Europe (Italy, Netherlands) and the Arab-Muslim civilization.
- One study addresses a global context.

Theoretical Framework:

- Three studies use classical elite theory.
- Two studies use network analysis.
- Two studies use field theory.
- One study uses institutional theory.
- One study uses patron-client theory.
- One study uses postmodern philosophy.
- One study uses a comparative historical approach.

- No mention found of a theoretical framework in one study.
- Three studies use a mixed theoretical approach.

Key Findings:

- Two studies outline theoretical frameworks or research directions without empirical findings.
- One study documents crisis and internal conflict among United States elites.
- One study distinguishes "true" and "pseudo" elites and shows elite-driven societal transformation in both Western and non-Western contexts.
- One study describes the rise of transnational and digital elites and new forms of elite power.

Theoretical Evolution of Elite Studies

Classical Foundations and Modern Adaptations

Study	Theoretical Approach	Key Concepts	Contemporary Applications	Regional Variations
Duka, 2008	Mixed: Classical elite theory, Institutional theory	Elites as functional groups, social layers, institutions	Theoretical frameworks for elite study; no direct application	No mention found
Zubarev, 2023	Classical elite theory, Network analysis	Continuity from Pareto, Mosca, Michels, Sorokin; network management	Expansion of research methods; elite reproduction in networked societies	No mention found
Masiutkina, 2021	Classical elite theory, patron-client, field theory	Hegemonism, creative minority, clientelism, fake news	Analysis of United States elite crisis, factionalism, and manipulation	United States (democracy)
Musaeva, 2024	No mention found (comparative historical)	"True" vs "pseudo" elite; elite-driven transformation	Case studies: Medici (Italy), Dutch elite, Quraish clan (Arab-Muslim)	Western Europe, Arab-Muslim world
Golovin and Golovina, 2021	Network analysis, Field theory, postmodern philosophy	Transnational/digital elites, virtual economies, postmodern values	Globalization of elite power, digital elite emergence	Global context

Theoretical Approaches:

- Classical elite theory is used in three studies.
- Network analysis is used in two studies.
- Field theory is used in two studies.

- Institutional theory, patron-client theory, postmodern philosophy, and comparative historical approaches are each used in one study.
- No mention found of a theoretical approach in one study (Musaeva, 2024; only comparative historical was mentioned).

Key Concepts (unique to each study):

- Duka, 2008: Functional groups, social layers, institutions.
- Zubarev, 2023: Elite reproduction, continuity from classical theorists, network management.
- Masiutkina, 2021: Hegemonism, creative minority, clientelism, fake news.
- Musaeva, 2024: "True" vs "pseudo" elite, elite-driven transformation.
- Golovin and Golovina, 2021: Transnational/digital elites, virtual economies, postmodern values.

Contemporary Applications:

- One study focuses only on theoretical frameworks with no direct application.
- One study discusses methodological expansion and elite reproduction in networked societies.
- One study analyzes elite crisis, factionalism, and manipulation in the United States.
- One study presents historical case studies (Medici, Dutch elite, Quraish clan).
- One study examines globalization of elite power and digital elite emergence.

Regional Variations:

- No mention found of regional information in two studies.
- One study focuses on the United States.
- One study includes both Western Europe and the Arab-Muslim world.
- One study has a global context.

Thematic Analysis

Patterns of Intra-Elite Conflict

Study	Theme	Western Context	Non-Western Context	Synthesis
Duka, 2008	Intra-elite conflict	No mention found	No mention found	Theoretical directions for studying elites; intra-elite dynamics not addressed
Zubarev, 2023	Elite circulation, reproduction	No mention found	No mention found	Focus on elite reproduction in networked societies; intra-elite conflict not detailed

Study	Theme	Western Context	Non-Western Context	Synthesis
Masiutkina, 2021	Factionalism, competition, elite circulation	United States: Crisis of identity, factionalism, clientelism, failure of elite selection	No mention found	Detailed empirical analysis of intra-elite conflict and circulation failure in United States context
Musaeva, 2024	Elite-driven transformation	Western Europe: Medici, Dutch elite	Arab-Muslim: Quraish clan	Focus on elite impact on societal change, not intra-elite conflict
Golovin and Golovina, 2021	Emergence of new elite forms	Global context: Transnational, digital elites	No mention found	Describes new elite forms and power, but not intra-elite conflict

Summary of Themes:

- One study focuses on intra-elite conflict (Masiutkina, 2021).
- One study focuses on elite circulation or reproduction (Zubarev, 2023).
- One study focuses on elite-driven transformation (Musaeva, 2024).
- One study describes the emergence of new elite forms (Golovin and Golovina, 2021).
- One study provides theoretical directions but does not address intra-elite dynamics (Duka, 2008).

Contextual Coverage:

- One study addresses both Western and non-Western contexts (Musaeva, 2024).
- Two studies address only Western contexts (Masiutkina, 2021; Golovin and Golovina, 2021).
- In two studies, we didn't find mention of either context.

Elite Circulation Mechanisms

Study	Theme	Western Context	Non-Western Context	Synthesis
Duka, 2008	Elite circulation (theoretical)	No mention found	No mention found	Suggests theoretical frameworks for studying elite circulation
Zubarev, 2023	Elite reproduction	No mention found	No mention found	Emphasizes mechanisms of elite reproduction in networked societies

Study	Theme	Western Context	Non-Western Context	Synthesis
Masiutkina, 2021	Elite selection, professionalism	United States: Crisis in elite selection, decline in professionalism	No mention found	Empirical evidence of elite circulation failure in United States
Musaeva, 2024	Elite transformation	Western Europe: Medici, Dutch elite	Arab-Muslim: Quraish clan	Focus on elite-driven societal transformation, not circulation mechanisms
Golovin and Golovina, 2021	Emergence of digital elites	Global context	No mention found	Describes new mechanisms of elite formation (digital, transnational)

Summary of Themes:

- Each study addresses a distinct aspect: theoretical elite circulation, elite reproduction, elite selection/professionalism, elite transformation, and digital elites.
- No theme is addressed by more than one study.

Contextual Overlap:

- Three studies address a Western or global context.
- Only one study (Musaeva, 2024) addresses both Western and non-Western contexts.
- No study addresses a non-Western context without also addressing a Western context.

Cultural Variations in Elite Structures

Study	Theme	Western Context	Non-Western Context	Synthesis
Duka, 2008	Theoretical perspectives	No mention found	No mention found	No explicit cultural comparison
Zubarev, 2023	Evolution of elite theory	No mention found	No mention found	No explicit cultural comparison
Masiutkina, 2021	Elite crisis	United States: Detailed analysis	No mention found	Focused on Western (United States) context

Study	Theme	Western Context	Non-Western Context	Synthesis
Musaeva, 2024	Comparative elite structures	Western Europe: Medici, Dutch elite	Arab-Muslim: Quraish clan	Provides comparative analysis of elite roles in societal transformation
Golovin and Golovina, 2021	Global elite forms	Global context	No mention found	Describes global convergence of elite forms (transnational, digital)

Summary of Cultural Comparisons:

- One study provides an explicit cultural comparison between Western and non-Western elite structures (Musaeva, 2024).
- One study focuses only on the Western (United States) context (Masiutkina, 2021).
- One study describes global or transnational convergence of elite forms (Golovin and Golovina, 2021).
- In two studies, we didn't find mention of a cultural comparison.

Brief Annotations of Key Publications

- Duka, 2008 : Theoretical analysis (no region specified); proposes three research directions for elite studies (functional groups, social layer, institutions); no empirical findings.
- Zubarev, 2023 : Theoretical/conceptual analysis (no region specified); traces evolution of elite theory, emphasizing network management and continuity from classical theory.
- Masiutkina, 2021 : Qualitative, historical, and conceptual analysis (United States); documents crisis of identity, factionalism, and elite circulation failure among United States elites; highlights rise of clientelism and manipulation.
- Musaeva, 2024 : Qualitative, comparative historical analysis (Western Europe: Italy, Netherlands; Arab-Muslim civilization); distinguishes "true" and "pseudo" elites; shows elite-driven societal transformation in both Western and non-Western contexts.
- Golovin and Golovina, 2021 : Theoretical/conceptual analysis (global context); describes rise of transnational and digital elites, blurring of national boundaries, and new forms of elite power.

Structured Comparisons

Western vs. Non-Western Understandings of Elites and Intra-Elite Conflict

- Western Contexts:
 - Masiutkina, 2021: Focuses on the United States, highlighting elite crisis, factionalism, and failure of elite circulation.

- Musaeva, 2024: Examines Western Europe (Medici, Dutch elite) in the context of elite-driven transformation.
- Golovin and Golovina, 2021: Addresses global/transnational elites, with implications for Western societies.
- Non-Western Contexts:
 - Musaeva, 2024: Analyzes the Quraish clan (Arab-Muslim civilization) as a case of elite-driven transformation.
 - No other studies provide detailed analysis of non-Western cases.
- Comparative Insights:
 - Only Musaeva, 2024, provides a direct comparison of Western and non-Western elite structures and their roles in societal transformation.
 - Other studies either focus on Western contexts or do not specify a regional focus.

Classical vs. Contemporary Approaches

- Classical Approaches:
 - Classical elite theory (Pareto, Mosca, Michels, Sorokin) is foundational in three studies.
 - Key concepts include functional groups, social layers, hegemonism, and creative minority.
- Contemporary Approaches:
 - Network analysis and field theory are used to analyze elite reproduction, digital elites, and transnational power.
 - Patron-client theory and postmodern philosophy are applied in specific studies to explain new forms of elite power and manipulation.
 - Comparative historical approaches are used to analyze elite-driven transformation across different societies.
- Integration:
 - Several studies use mixed approaches, combining classical theory with contemporary frameworks (network analysis, field theory, institutional theory).

Open Questions and Ideas Useful for World-Building

Based on the included studies, the following open questions and conceptual ideas emerge:

- Elite Circulation and Reproduction: How do mechanisms of elite reproduction differ between networked societies and traditional hierarchical structures? (Zubarev, 2023; Duka, 2008)
- Intra-Elite Conflict: What are the consequences of elite circulation failure and increased factionalism for political stability, as observed in the United States? (Masiutkina, 2021)
- Elite-Driven Transformation: How do "true" and "pseudo" elites shape societal transformation differently in Western and non-Western contexts? (Musaeva, 2024)

- Transnational and Digital Elites: What new forms of power and competition arise with the emergence of digital and transnational elites, and how do these forms blur traditional national boundaries? (Golovin and Golovina, 2021)
- Theoretical Synthesis: How can classical elite theory be integrated with contemporary approaches (network analysis, field theory, patron-client relations) to better understand elite dynamics in both democratic and authoritarian regimes? (Duka, 2008; Zubarev, 2023; Masiutkina, 2021; Golovin and Golovina, 2021)

References

- M. Z. Musaeva. "ELITE AS A FACTOR OF TRANSFORMATION OF SOCIAL EXISTENCE." *BULLETIN OF CHECHEN STATE PEDAGOGICAL UNIVERSITY Series 2. Psychological and Philosophical Sciences*, 2024.
- Viktoriiia R. Masiutkina. " : ." , 2021.
- Vyacheslav G. Golovin, and Ekaterina E. Golovina. " ," 2021.
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